Snaptext

Private, offline OCR for your PC

User Guide · Installation · Tips & Tricks

Version 1.1 · Alkhair Soft

1. Welcome to Snaptext

Snaptext turns any document, image or screenshot into clean, editable text in seconds. It runs entirely on your computer — your files never leave the machine and no internet connection is needed.

Most people don't own a scanner, so Snaptext is built around **import**: drop in a PDF or photo, paste a screenshot, or grab any region of your screen. The text appears instantly, ready to copy into a report, email or spreadsheet.

What you can do

- **Import & read** PDFs, photos and scans — get Markdown, plain text or JSON.
- **Snaptext Lens** — freeze the screen, draw a box you can resize and move, pick the lines you want, and copy them. Works from any app with `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `L` .
- **OMR answer sheets** — print bubble sheets, then read and grade a whole class from scans or phone photos.
- **Handwriting mode** — read handwritten English notes and letters (free Handwriting Pack).
- **Keep a log** of everything you've scanned, with confidence scores and timings.
- **Work offline & private** — no cloud, no account, no telemetry.
- **Fast on any PC** — about one page per second, no graphics card required.

Supported files: PDF, PNG, JPG, TIFF, BMP, WebP. Languages: Latin (≈50 languages), Cyrillic, Greek, Devanagari, Bengali and Chinese.

2. Installation

System requirements

Item	Requirement
Operating system	Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit)
Disk space	About 350 MB
Memory	4 GB RAM or more
Internet	Not required — everything runs locally

Install in four steps

1. Double-click **Snaptext-Setup.exe**.
2. If Windows shows a blue "Windows protected your PC" screen, click **More info** → **Run anyway** (this appears because the installer is not yet code-signed).
3. Choose the install folder (the default is fine) and click **Install**.
4. Tick **Launch Snaptext** and click **Finish**.

Snaptext adds a **Start Menu** and **desktop** shortcut, and puts the `snaptext` command on your PATH so you can use screen capture from any terminal.

> **Tip:** the first launch takes a few extra seconds while Windows checks the new app and the OCR engine warms up. After that it opens quickly.

3. Your first scan

1. Open **Snaptext** from the Start Menu. It opens in its own window on the **Scan** view.
2. Drag a PDF or image onto the big **Import** panel — or click it to browse, or press `Ctrl` + `V` to paste a screenshot.
3. The page appears in the middle with coloured boxes around each line of detected text.
4. On the right, pick **Preview**, **Markdown**, **Text** or **JSON**, then click **Copy** or **Download**.

Reading the colours

Each line box is coloured by how confident Snaptext is:

Colour	Meaning
Green	High confidence (90%+) — almost certainly correct.
Amber	Medium (80–90%) — worth a glance.
Red	Low (under 80%) — check this line.

Hover any box to see the text and its confidence; click a box to copy just that line.

4. The Scan and Log views

Scan view

- **Import panel** — drag & drop, browse, or paste. Imported files are listed below it.
- **Scan options** — choose *Auto* (use a PDF's own text when it is good), *Always OCR*, or *PDF text only*; set the render DPI; turn on maths (LaTeX) or keep headers/footers.
- **Page view** — switch overlays between *Lines*, *Blocks*, *Reading order* and *Clean*; zoom; page through multi-page files.
- **Results** — Preview / Markdown / Text / Lines / JSON, for the current page or the whole document.

Log view

Every scan is recorded in **Log** with a thumbnail, time, page count, line count and confidence. Click a row to reopen it, export the whole log to CSV, or clear it. The log is kept on your computer only.

Re-scan with different options: change the scan options and click **Re-scan** — Snaptext re-reads the same file without you importing it again.

5. Capture text from the screen

When there is no file to import — text inside another app, a video still, a message box — Snaptext grabs it straight off the screen, right from the main window. It works just like the Windows Snipping Tool.

Snaptext Lens — the easy way

1. Press `Ctrl + Alt + L` in any app (while Snaptext is open), or click **Snaptext Lens** on the Scan view. The screen freezes and dims.
2. **Drag a box** over the text. The box stays on screen: drag its **corners or edges** to resize it, drag **inside** it to move it, or nudge it with the arrow keys.
3. Every line inside is read and highlighted. **Click a line** to pick it (it turns blue), or press `Ctrl + A` to pick them all.
4. Click **Copy text** (or press `Ctrl + C`) — the picked lines, or all of them, go to your clipboard. **Open in Snaptext** (`Enter`) sends the capture to the app instead.

Press `Esc` at any time to cancel. If another program already uses `Ctrl + Alt + L`, Snaptext picks `Ctrl + Shift + L` or `Ctrl + Alt + K` and shows the key on the Scan view.

The capture box also has **Quick snip** (draw a box, done), **Pick a window** and **Whole screen**. Every capture is saved to your **Log** just like an imported file.

For power users — the snaptext command

Prefer the keyboard? The same captures are available from any terminal, plus global hotkeys and batch options. Open a terminal (press `Win`, type *cmd*, Enter) and run `snaptext region`.

All capture commands

Command	What it does
snaptext region	Draw a box on screen, OCR it, copy the text.
snaptext window	OCR the active window (switch to it during the countdown).
snaptext screen	OCR the whole monitor under the mouse.
snaptext clipboard	OCR an image already copied (e.g. from Win+Shift+S).
snaptext file a.pdf	OCR files to Markdown; add --out FOLDER to save.
snaptext watch	Run in the background with global hotkeys (below).
snaptext ui	Open the full Snaptext window.

Hotkeys (while `snaptext watch` is running)

Hotkey	Action
Ctrl + Alt + O	Capture a region
Ctrl + Alt + W	Capture the active window

Hotkey	Action
Ctrl + Alt + S	Capture the screen
Ctrl + Alt + Q	Stop watching

Handy switches: `--append report.md` adds every capture to a running report; `--history` keeps each capture and its text; `--scale 3` helps with very small text; `--format md` keeps tables.

6. OMR — bubble answer sheets

Snaptext prints multiple-choice answer sheets and reads them back — from a scanner or a phone photo — then grades them against your answer key. Open the **OMR** tab on the left.

1 · Create a sheet

1. Enter a title, the number of questions, the options per question (A–B up to A–F) and how many digits the roll number has.
2. Click **Download sheet (PDF)**, print it and hand it out. Every sheet carries four black corner squares and a code strip along the bottom, so Snaptext recognises its layout by itself.

2 · The answer key (optional)

Type the key as `ABCDA…` or `1-A, 2-C, 3-B…` (use `-` to skip a question), or fill in one sheet yourself, read it, select it and click **Use the selected sheet as the key**. Choose a wrong-answer penalty if you use negative marking.

3 · Read the filled sheets

Drop the scans or photos (JPG, PNG, or a multi-page PDF of the whole stack) onto **Read filled sheets**. Each sheet becomes a row with the roll number, score, percentage, blanks and double marks, plus the class average. Click a row to see the straightened sheet with every mark circled: green right, red wrong, a dashed blue ring on the correct answer, orange for a double mark. **Export CSV** gives you a spreadsheet with every answer.

For best results	
Photos	Lay the sheet flat, fill the frame, keep all four corner squares in view.
Pens	Dark pen or soft (HB/2B) pencil; fill the bubble completely.
Changes	Erase fully — a half-erased mark can count as a double mark.

Changing the key or the penalty re-grades every sheet instantly — no need to read them again. Each sheet read counts as one scan.

7. Handwriting mode

Snaptext's main engine is built for printed text. For handwritten notes, letters and forms, install the free **Snaptext Handwriting Pack** (`Snaptext-Handwriting-Pack.exe`, about 480 MB): it adds a dedicated handwriting model and works fully offline.

1. Run **Snaptext-Handwriting-Pack.exe** (Snaptext must already be installed).
2. Open Snaptext. In **Scan options**, tick **Handwriting mode**.
3. Import or capture as usual. Snaptext finds each line and reads it with the handwriting model.

In our tests on real handwritten pages it cut character errors from 14% to 6.5% and word errors from 37% to 15%.

Good to know

- It reads **English** handwriting. Other scripts are not improved.
- It is slower — about a second per line, so a full page takes around ten seconds.
- Whole lines and pages read best; a single isolated word is right about half the time.
- Turn it off for printed documents — the normal engine is faster and better there.

8. Trial and licensing

Snaptext is free to try for 30 days with every feature unlocked.

Period	What you get
Days 1–30	Unlimited scans, all features.
After 30 days	Free tier: 3 scans per day (a scan = one document or one capture).
Licensed	Unlimited, forever, offline — tied to this one computer.

Activate a licence

1. Click the licence chip at the top-right of the window.
2. Copy your **Machine ID** and send it to Alkhair Soft.
3. You'll receive a licence file (`.qslic`). Open the chip again, paste its contents into the box and click **Activate**.

The licence is bound to your Machine ID, so it works offline forever on this computer. Moving to a new PC needs a new licence (its Machine ID is different).

Privacy: Snaptext sends nothing anywhere — no usage data, no documents, no licence checks over the internet. Everything above works with your network cable unplugged.

9. Tips & tricks

- **Paste beats importing.** For anything on screen, `Ctrl + V` straight into the Scan view is the fastest route.
- **Keep snaptext watch running** in the background and use `Ctrl + Alt + O` whenever you need text — it's always one shortcut away.
- **Low-confidence (red) lines** are where mistakes hide. Glance at them before trusting a scan.
- **Tables:** use the **Markdown** output — Snaptext keeps table structure, which plain text loses.
- **Tiny or blurry text:** add `--scale 3` on the command line, or raise the DPI in the Scan options.
- **Scanned PDFs that already have text** read fastest in *Auto* mode; force *Always OCR* only when the built-in text is wrong.
- **Build a report** from several captures with `snaptext region --append notes.md`.
- **Dark-mode screenshots** are handled automatically; the colours are inverted before reading.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"Windows protected your PC" on install	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The app is safe but not yet code-signed.
The app is slow to open the first time	Normal — Windows scans the new app and the engine warms up. It's quick afterwards.
"snaptext" is not recognised in the terminal	Open a **new** terminal after installing (PATH updates apply to new windows), or restart.
Trial ended, limited to 3 a day	Enter a licence via the chip to remove the limit. Your Machine ID is shown there.
Text came out wrong on a bad scan	Raise the DPI or use --scale. For handwriting, install the Handwriting Pack and tick Handwriting mode.
Arabic / Urdu text not recognised	The engine does not support Arabic-script, Hebrew, Thai, Japanese kana or Korean.

Support: alkhairsoft@live.com

Snaptext is powered by the open-source Snaptext OCR engine.